[Resilience X

Remote and Hybrid Work Policy

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1.0 Introduction

1.1 Our Philosophy on Flexible Work

At [Resilience X, we believe that talent is not confined to a single location. Our success is driven by the exceptional people who choose to build their careers with us, and we are committed to creating an environment where they can do their best work. We recognize that flexibility is a key component of a modern, productive, and engaging workplace.

Our approach to remote and hybrid work is rooted in trust, empowerment, and a focus on results. We aim to provide our employees with the flexibility to balance their professional and personal lives while ensuring we maintain a strong, collaborative culture and continue to deliver outstanding results for our customers. This policy is designed to provide a framework that supports both employee autonomy and business objectives.

1.2 Purpose and Scope

The purpose of this document is to outline the policies, procedures, and expectations for employees working in hybrid and remote arrangements at [Resilience X. It provides clarity on eligibility, responsibilities, and the resources available to support a successful flexible work experience.

This policy applies to all regular full-time and part-time employees of the company. It does not apply to temporary staff, contractors, or interns, whose work arrangements are defined by their specific agreements. The provisions of this policy are subject to applicable local laws and regulations in the jurisdictions where we operate.

1.3 A Shared Commitment

A successful flexible work model requires a shared commitment from everyone.

- **The Company commits to providing the necessary technology, resources, and support to enable productive work from any location. We commit to measuring performance based on outcomes, not presence, and to fostering an inclusive culture for all employees, regardless of where they work.**
- **Employees commit to maintaining high levels of performance, productivity, and communication. They commit to creating a safe and effective home workspace and to actively participating in team and company culture.**

1.4 Key Definitions

- **Hybrid Work: An arrangement where an employee works some days of the week at a designated company office and other days from a remote location (typically their home).**
- **Remote Work: An arrangement where an employee works 100% of the time from a home office located in an approved state or country and is not required to come to an office on a regular basis.**
- **Office-Based Work: An arrangement where an employee's role requires them to be physically present at a company office for 100% of their working hours.**
- **Home Office: The designated remote workspace, typically within the employee's home, that is approved for work.**
- **Anchor Days: Specific, pre-determined days when hybrid teams are required to come into the office to facilitate in-person collaboration.**

- **HRIS: The company's Human Resources Information System (e.g., Workday), which is the system of record for an employee's designated work model and location.**

2.0 Our Work Models

2.1 Overview of Work Models

To accommodate the diverse needs of our teams and roles, we have established three primary work models. Your specific model is determined by the nature of your role, team requirements, and business needs.

Work Model	Description	Primary Work Location	Office Attendance
Hybrid	A mix of in-office and remote work each week.	Employee's Home & Company Office	Required on specific "anchor days" (e.g., 2-3 days/week)
Remote	Work is performed 100% from an approved home office.	Employee's Home Office	Not required regularly; occasional travel for key meetings.
Office-Based	Work requires full-time physical presence on-site.	Company Office	100% of working hours.

2.2 The Hybrid Model

The Hybrid model is our standard and most common arrangement. It offers the best of both worlds: the flexibility and focus of remote work combined with the collaboration, connection, and serendipitous innovation that comes from in-person interaction. The specific number of in-office days is determined by the team and leadership.

2.3 The Remote Model

The Remote model is for roles that can be performed effectively without a regular physical presence in an office. This model allows us to attract and retain talent from a wider geographic pool. Remote employees are a vital part of our community and are fully integrated into their teams through virtual collaboration tools and practices.

2.4 The Office-Based Model

Certain roles, by their nature, require a consistent on-site presence. This includes positions in facilities management, on-site IT support, lab-based research, and certain client-facing roles that require in-person service delivery.

2.5 Determining the Appropriate Work Model

The default work model for a role is determined by the hiring manager and departmental leadership, in consultation with HR. The decision is based on an objective assessment of factors including:

- **The nature of the work and core job responsibilities.**
- **The level of required in-person collaboration with colleagues, clients, or partners.**
- **The need for access to specialized equipment or secure facilities located in an office.**

Your designated work model is formally recorded in the HRIS.

3.0 Eligibility and Application

3.1 General Eligibility Criteria

"Am I eligible for WFH?" Eligibility for a hybrid or remote work arrangement is primarily based on the nature of your role. However, individual employee eligibility also requires:

- **Satisfactory Performance: A consistent record of meeting or exceeding performance expectations.**
- **Demonstrated Autonomy: The ability to work independently, manage time effectively, and stay motivated without direct supervision.**
- **Appropriate Home Office: A designated, safe, and distraction-free workspace with a reliable, high-speed internet connection.**
- **Tenure: New employees may be required to work from an office for an initial period (e.g., the first 90 days) to facilitate onboarding, training, and integration into the company culture before becoming eligible for a flexible arrangement.**

3.2 Applying for a Remote or Hybrid Arrangement

Employees interested in changing their work model (e.g., moving from Hybrid to Remote) should first have a discussion with their manager. If the manager is supportive, the employee must submit a formal "Flexible Work Arrangement Request" form through the HR portal. The request should outline the reasons for the request and confirm that all eligibility criteria are met.

3.3 The Approval Process

1. **Manager Review: The manager reviews the request, considering team dynamics, fairness, and business needs.**
2. **HR & Department Head Review: If the manager approves, the request is routed to HR and the department head for final review and approval. This step ensures consistency and compliance with policy.**
3. **HRIS Update: Once approved, HR will update the employee's official work model and location in the HRIS.**

The company reserves the right to deny any request based on business needs, performance concerns, or other job-related factors.

3.4 Trial Periods and Adjustments

Any newly approved hybrid or remote arrangement will be subject to a 90-day trial period. During this time, the employee and manager will regularly check in to assess the effectiveness of the arrangement. The company may end the arrangement at any time if it is not supporting business needs or if the employee's performance declines.

3.5 Case Example: Transitioning to a Remote Role

- **Scenario: Maria, a high-performing marketing manager in the Hybrid model, needs to relocate to a different state for family reasons. Her role can be performed remotely.**

- **Action:**
    1. **Maria discusses her situation with her manager, who agrees that Maria can effectively perform her duties remotely.**
    2. **Maria submits a formal request form, detailing her proposed new location and confirming her home office will meet company standards.**
    3. **The request is approved by her manager, the VP of Marketing, and HR. HR confirms that the new state is an approved location for remote work.**
    4. **Maria's status is officially changed to "Remote" in the HRIS, and HR discusses potential compensation adjustments based on the new geographic location.**

4.0 Expectations for Hybrid Employees

4.1 Structuring the Hybrid Week

The standard hybrid model at [Resilience X is three (3) days in the office and two (2) days remote. Department leaders may adjust this standard based on business needs. Your specific in-office days will be determined by your team.

4.2 Anchor Days and Team Collaboration

To maximize the benefit of in-person time, teams will establish "anchor days." These are specific days of the week (e.g., Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday) when all team members are expected to be in the office. The purpose of anchor days is to facilitate collaborative work, team meetings, brainstorming sessions, and informal social connection.

4.3 Office Space and Resources (Hot-Desking)

To support a hybrid workforce, our offices are designed with flexible seating. Hybrid employees will not have assigned desks. You will be required to book a desk in advance using our "hot-desking" or "hoteling" software. This ensures you have a workspace when you come in and allows us to manage our office space efficiently.

4.4 Ad-Hoc Flexibility

We understand that life happens. If you need to swap an in-office day for a remote day due to a personal appointment or other need, you should discuss it with your manager. These occasional adjustments are generally supported, provided they do not conflict with critical in-person meetings.

4.5 Case Example: A Hybrid Team's Weekly Cadence

- **Scenario: An engineering team has designated Tuesday and Wednesday as their anchor days.**
- **Weekly Schedule:**
    - **Monday: Most of the team works remotely, focusing on individual coding tasks.**
    - **Tuesday (Anchor Day): The full team is in the office for sprint planning, a design workshop, and a team lunch.**

- **Wednesday (Anchor Day): Team members are in the office for cross-functional meetings and pair programming.**
- **Thursday: Some members choose this as their third in-office day, while others work remotely.**
- **Friday: Most of the team works remotely, wrapping up weekly tasks.**

5.0 Expectations for Remote Employees

5.1 Primary Workspace Requirements

Remote employees must maintain a designated primary workspace that is safe, secure, and ergonomically sound. This location must be your official address on record in the HRIS.

5.2 Travel to Company Offices

While remote employees do not have a regular office commute, they are required to travel to a company office for key business events. This may include:

- **Quarterly planning meetings**
- **Team offsites or all-hands events**
- **Important client meetings**
- **Mandatory training programs**
  Travel expenses for such required trips will be covered by the company in accordance with the Travel and Expense Policy.

5.3 Working from Alternate Locations

Remote work is not a license to be a "digital nomad." Your approved remote location is your primary residence.

- **Short-Term Work from Another Location: You may work from a different domestic location for a short period (e.g., up to 4 weeks per year) with prior approval from your manager. This is to ensure there are no tax or legal implications.**
- **International Work: Working from another country is strictly prohibited without prior, exceptional approval from HR and Legal, as it creates significant tax, immigration, and compliance risks.**

5.4 Geographic Pay Considerations

Our compensation strategy is to pay competitively based on the local market. If a remote employee moves from a high-cost-of-labor location to a lower-cost-of-labor location, their base salary and salary range may be adjusted to align with the new local market. Any such adjustments will be discussed transparently with the employee before a move is finalized.

6.0 Technology, Equipment, and Home Office

6.1 Company-Provided Equipment

"Who provides laptops for remote?" The company is committed to ensuring you have the primary tools needed for your job. For all hybrid and remote employees, [Resilience X will provide:

- **A company-standard laptop**
- **One external monitor**
- **Keyboard and mouse**
- **Headset**
- **Any specialized software required for your role**
  This equipment remains the property of the company at all times.

6.2 Home Office Stipend

To help you create a comfortable and productive workspace, the company offers a one-time, taxable Home Office Stipend of [e.g., $500] to new remote and hybrid employees. This stipend can be used for items such as:

- **An ergonomic office chair**
- **A desk**
- **Improved lighting**
- **Other essential office furniture or accessories**

6.3 Employee Responsibilities for Home Office

Employees are responsible for providing and maintaining:

- **A reliable, high-speed internet connection that meets the minimum speed requirements set by the IT department.**
- **A safe and secure home office environment.**
- **Utility costs (e.g., electricity, internet service).**

6.4 Technical Support

Our IT Help Desk provides full support to remote and hybrid employees. Support can be accessed via phone, chat, or remote desktop assistance. For hardware issues requiring physical repair, you will be provided with instructions on how to ship your equipment to our IT department.

6.5 Return of Company Property

Upon separation from the company, you are required to return all company-provided equipment. The company will provide a pre-paid shipping box and instructions for returning the items.

7.0 Productivity, Communication, and Performance

7.1 Core Working Hours and Availability

Flexible work is not an exemption from a full-time commitment. All employees, regardless of location, are expected to be available and online during core business hours, which are [e.g., 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM] in their local time zone. You should maintain a calendar that is visible to your colleagues, keeping it updated with your work status and availability.

7.2 Communication Best Practices

In a flexible work environment, deliberate communication is key.

- **Be Responsive: Acknowledge messages from colleagues in a timely manner.**
- **Default to Open: Use public team channels (e.g., in Slack or Teams) for work-related discussions whenever possible to ensure visibility.**
- **Camera On: We have a "camera on" culture for video meetings to foster connection and improve communication.**

7.3 Performance Expectations

Performance standards are the same for all employees. You will be evaluated based on the results you deliver and your contributions to your team's goals, not on the number of hours you spend in an office or online.

8.0 Data Security and Confidentiality

8.1 Protecting Company Information

You are responsible for protecting confidential company and customer information at all times. This includes:

- **Ensuring your computer screen is not visible to unauthorized individuals.**
- **Not leaving company equipment unattended in public places.**
- **Using a secure paper shredder for any printed sensitive documents.**

8.2 Secure Network Usage

When working remotely, you must connect to the internet via a secure, password-protected network. Use of public, unsecured Wi-Fi for work is strictly prohibited. All remote access to the company network must be done through the company-provided Virtual Private Network (VPN).

9.0 Health, Safety, and Well-being

9.1 Ergonomic Workspace

You are responsible for setting up an ergonomically sound workspace to minimize the risk of injury. HR provides an online ergonomics self-assessment tool and guide to help you.

9.2 Workers' Compensation

Workers' compensation coverage applies to work-related injuries that occur in your approved home office during your defined work hours. You must report any such injury to your manager and HR immediately.

11.0 Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1: Am I eligible for remote or hybrid work (WFH)?
A: Eligibility is primarily determined by your role's function. If your job can be done away from the office, you are likely eligible for a hybrid or remote model, provided you meet performance standards and have an appropriate home office setup.

Q2: Who provides the equipment like laptops for remote work?
A: The company provides essential equipment, including a laptop, monitor, keyboard, mouse, and headset. You are responsible for your own internet service and office furniture.

Q3: Does the company provide money to set up my home office?
A: Yes, eligible new remote and hybrid employees receive a one-time, taxable stipend of [e.g., $500] to help purchase a desk, chair, or other essential items.

Q4: If I am in the Hybrid model, do I have to come in on specific days?
A: Yes. Teams establish "anchor days" when all members are expected to be in the office to maximize in-person collaboration.

Q5: Can I work from a different state or country for a few weeks?
A: You may work from a different domestic location for up to four weeks per year with manager approval. Working internationally is strictly prohibited without exceptional approval from HR and Legal due to complex tax and compliance risks.

Q6: If I am a remote employee, will my salary change if I move?
A: Possibly. Our pay is based on the local market. If you move from a higher-cost location to a lower-cost one, your salary may be adjusted to align with the new market rate. This will be discussed with you before you move.

Q7: Can the company change my work arrangement from Remote back to Hybrid?
A: Yes. While we aim to provide stability, the company reserves the right to modify work arrangements based on changing business needs, team structure, or performance considerations.

12.0 Revision History

Version	Date of Revision	Summary of Changes	Approved By
1.0	Jan 1, 2024	Initial release of the comprehensive Remote and Hybrid Work Policy.	Executive Leadership Team